



After the battle

Events like the Union bombardment of Fredericksburg in 1862 inevitably took their toll on morale. A painting by David E. Henderson shows a family amid the devastation.

"Copperhead" Democrats

Some states of the Union, such as Minnesota and Iowa, were more concerned about Indian uprisings than the Southern rebellion. Others were so remote from the effects of the war and its sacrifices that Confederate independence did not seem like a terrible prospect. Still other sections, such as southern Ohio, Pennsylvania, Indiana, and Illinois, at times outrightly resisted the Federal war effort, not only by protesting the draft laws, but also by electing antiwar or "Copperhead" Democrats to the state and national legislatures.

The Copperheads earned their nickname from the copper pennies they supposedly wore on their coat lapels as identification. They controlled a strong minority in the national Democratic Party,